



# PATCH 2026

## COHORT

36

PATCHERS

72%

NON  
DUBLIN

38%

WOMEN

- ✓ Stripe Young Scientist winners
- ✓ Olympiad finalists & Team Ireland competitors
- ✓ Technology used by Olympic athletes
- ✓ Space, start ups and science
- ✓ Built AI systems, rockets, drones & medical devices

7 WEEKS  
TO BUILD SOMETHING GREAT

From 450+  
applications across  
every county in Ireland



500K+

Users reached



13M+

Social Media  
Views



20+

National STEM +  
Innovation Awards



€110K+

Revenue  
generated



220K+

Downloads

stripe



OpenAI

dogpatch  
LABS

RETHINK  
IRELAND

Our  
Social  
Innovation  
Fund



Abbey Capital





## **Aoibheann Daly | 16 | Kerry**

Aoibheann has a passion for AI, neuroscience, and entrepreneurship. She developed an explainable AI system for diffuse glioma prognosis and a cervical cancer detection model for low-resource settings. This work led to her win at the Stripe Young Scientist and Technologist of the Year 2026. Outside of STEM, she loves art and playing camogie.



## **Dónal Ó Conalláin | 20 | Leitrim**

Donal studies Engineering in Trinity. He is passionate about welding and runs his own fabrication company at home in Leitrim. He is Head of Manufacturing with Formula Trinity, helping to build a race car to compete in Formula Student UK this summer. He previously designed the exhaust manifold for the powertrain department.



## **Beatrice Cesonyte | 17 | Cork**

Beatrice represented Ireland three times in the European Girls' Olympiad in Informatics. She has a passion for programming and all things IT, and entered Young Scientist with her project "The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Manosphere". Alongside software, she is into F1 (especially Max Verstappen), rowing and tennis.



## **Paddy Corcoran | 17 | Tipperary**

Paddy co-built Studytok alongside Seán, an educational platform that makes studying as engaging as social media and has passed 220K+ downloads. He is drawn to startups, software, and digital product design, with a particular focus on product growth, internet culture, and building things with real-world impact.



## **Seán Cahill | 18 | Tipperary**

Seán co-created Studytok with Paddy and won the innovation award at the Student Enterprise Programme national finals. He travelled to San Francisco through Emergent Ventures funding to meet founders and builders, and hopes to study robotics in the US. His interests sit at the intersection of software engineering, startups, and space.



## **Kaisín Manning | 19 | Wicklow**

Kaisín studies Mechatronics Engineering and adores rockets, robots and design. She has competed in robowars and won the 2024 Coolest-Projects Advanced Programming category using OpenGL. She is currently designing and building a parachute for the Eirspace team. Her next goal is to secure a radio license for creative rocket payloads.

# 2026 Cohort



## Aoife Fadian | 17 | Sligo

Aoife is interested in music and business. Her research using sheep wool as a sustainable strengthening agent for concrete won Overall Best Group at the Stripe Young Scientist 2026. Outside of STEM, she holds 8 All-Ireland Fleadh Cheoil medals across various instruments, won Siansa Gael Linn and is the current U18 uilleann pipes champion.



## Holly Feehan | 20 | Cork

Holly is on a European Solidarity Corps gap year and is passionate about space law. Her research into globalisation was recognised at the Young Sociologist of the Year. A multi-time Texaco Art awardee, she is currently building a kinetic underframe for projection mapping to bridge her love for art and hardware. She's an avid 35mm film photographer.



## Aidan O'Sullivan | 20 | Kerry

Aidan is an electrical engineer and the founder of Reeward, a QR-based loyalty network for local businesses. He previously built LC GPT, an AI study platform for Irish students, a voice AI ordering assistant, and runs a seasonal sauna business in Ballinskelligs. He attended Y Combinator's AI Startup School and plays Gaelic football.



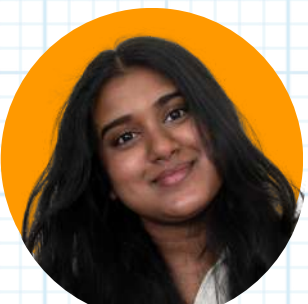
## Rachel Keaveney | 20 | Mayo

Rachel has worked on projects ranging from a predictive maintenance model for wind turbines using machine learning, to Instruct.Web, a platform supporting people who struggle with daily routines due to disability. Before switching to computer science, Rachel spent a year studying art education. She loves to draw and work on projects.



## Colm Rea | 17 | Cork

Colm is passionate about engineering and robotics. He founded a VEX Robotics club and lead it to the number 1 rank in Europe and on to the World Championships in St. Louis, Missouri. He loves Inline Hockey and has competed with Team Ireland twice. He is Vice-Chair of his school's debating club and in his free time loves reading and film.



## Iniya Baskaran | 19 | Dublin

An Interaction Design student at NCAD, Iniya has won the IADT 24 Hour Design Challenge two years running, earned a place in the Top 100 Youth Ideathon, and reached the RISE finals. A theatre kid at heart, her design interests span digital interactions, physical computing, gender equality, and community-focused design.



## **Fionn Crinion | 17 | Dublin**

Fionn builds engineering systems focused on sports and performance. He developed a pacing light system now used by Athletics Ireland and even some Olympic athletes. He is interested in electronics, embedded systems, and product design, and enjoys developing practical technology that can be tested and used in real-world scenarios.



## **Aadila Aliu Iyamah | 18 | Mayo**

Aadila is interested in engineering, biology, and AI. She created an app using sign language recognition, eye-tracking, and a flex-sensor glove to support people with speech disabilities. She has taken part in many science competitions and is a member of the National Youth Assembly. Outside STEM, she plays badminton and camogie.



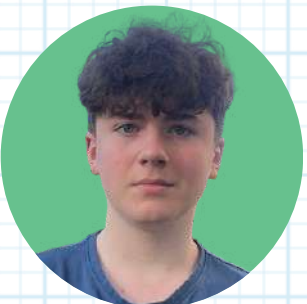
## **Darragh Evanson | 19 | Dublin**

Darragh studies engineering with management. He led the hardware design of a 3D-printed digital stethoscope, utilising AI for arrhythmia diagnosis and classification, winning national awards at Google London. He has independently designed and manufactured a custom wheelchair lift. In his free time, Darragh is an avid rock climber.



## **Sarah Hurley | 17 | Limerick**

As an established team leader, Sarah loves solving real-world problems with tech & creative approaches. She has earned 7 STEM-Related awards and enjoys coding, UI design and software development. She also has a passion for multimedia creation and is a published photographer and videographer with multiple video editing related awards.



## **Odin Glynn-Martin | 16 | Mayo**

Odin is a researcher focused on machine learning and AI systems. His projects include distributed LLM bias-detection systems, computer vision tools for bird conservation research, and large-scale RSS indexing infrastructure. Outside of this, he photographs the Irish countryside and builds custom photography software and web tools.



## **Paula Brüdrieh | 21 | Dublin**

Paula is the powertrain lead of the Formula Trinity and a Trinity College Scholar. She has previously worked in hardware development for logistics drones. She is especially interested in how tech can help manage chronic illness, mainly through the food industry. In her free time she works on embroidery and taking aerial silks classes



# 2026 Cohort



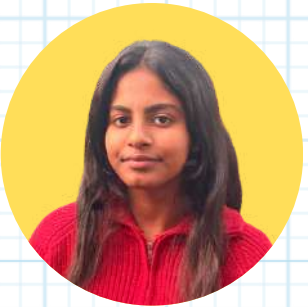
## Deepta Suresh | 17 | Galway

Deepta has a strong passion for biology, medicine, and medical technology. She recently filed a patent for an innovative insulin-eluting stent to treat diabetes, and has won multiple awards for that project as well as for her research on artificial sweeteners and the gut microbiome. She loves walking, painting, and sport.



## Alex O'Loghlen | 17 | Dublin

Alex has participated in Model United Nations competition nationally and internationally, winning awards in both. He established a STEM club in his school where he is building a drone. He is currently working on a lab technician robotic arm and a snake robot that uses lateral undulation to move. He also enjoys basketball and running.



## Srinidhi Karthik | 16 | Westmeath

Srinidhi enjoys drawing, 3D modelling, and debating. She is a 3x 1st in category at YSTE, with projects on bias in AI, a mathematical optimisation problem, and forgetting & alignment drift in machine learning. She is researching a NeuroAI project focused on brain connectivity networks and will represent Ireland at the STEM Racing World Final.



## Tommy Byrne | 20 | Laois

Tommy is a Computer Science student keen on embedded systems and free and open source software. He is part of Formula Trinity, working with both the Hardware and ADS teams. He also serves as DU Pirate Party's Events Officer. In his spare time he can be found bouldering, learning Japanese, and competing in the Overwatch IECS league.



## Kelvin Gao | 20 | Cavan

Kelvin is an electrical engineer and an All Ireland Scholar with a fiery passion for an autonomous and cleaner future. Kelvin has co-authored a paper on autonomous maintenance that won 2nd in EirGrid's Cleaner grid competition for wind energy. He will compete with UCD's UAV team working on autopilot after winning 2 awards last year.



## Mac O'Brien | 18 | Wicklow

Mac is interested in entrepreneurship, sales, and digital business. He has built and scaled multiple ventures, including AGNT, developing experience in leadership, operations, and scaling service-based businesses. Outside business, he is interested in history and psychology, and is confident he'll become president of Ireland in 2046.

# 2026 Cohort



## Lorcan Grimes | 22 | Tyrone

As Head of Rocketry for Northern Ireland's largest student team, aerospace engineering student Lorcan, manages a £15K contract to oversee design, manufacture, and testing of a launch vehicle and climate science payload. He achieved the highest possible grade in the European Space Agency's Space Standards course and is skilled in aircraft design.



## Owais Korejo | 19 | Dublin

Owais built and scaled an e-commerce poster business to over \$110K in sales before founding Grooooves, a music-reviewing app that has already reached thousands of users and millions of views across social media. He was a finalist in the Irish Programming Olympiad and enjoys reading about business, psychology, philosophy and theology.



## James O'Sullivan | 17 | Cork

James has interests in mathematics, robotics, and engineering, as well as film and cycling. He received an Honourable Mention in the Irish Mathematical Olympiad and ranked #1 in Europe in VEX Mid-Season Robotics. His projects include smart glasses that use hearing aids as speakers and a voice- and gesture-controlled computer interface.



## Ben Hewston | 20 | Dublin

Ben's a builder. He's designed and installed a home automation system, including 30+ custom smart light switches. At 14, he built a fully furnished garden room that now serves as his workshop for electronics, 3D printing and software projects. He also helps run one of Ireland's biggest Junior Hockey Clubs of over 750 children.



## Moaz Refaei | 21 | Dublin

Moaz is interested in analog design, embedded systems, and sustainable engineering. He interned at Stryker, serves as avionics lead on UCD's UAV team, and led ElecSoc through its biggest year on record as president. He has won awards for his research on autonomous underwater vehicles for offshore renewable energy inspection.



## Basil Amin | 17 | Dublin

Basil is a 5th year student and is, at heart, an engineer, creator, and scientist. His work includes a thrust vectored model scale rocket as his first project, which he presented on national television, and a smart insole to reduce the complications of a neurodiabetic disorder using hybrid AI analysis. Basil enjoys shooting, Arabic poetry, and politics



## Ananyaa Rahate | 18 | Antrim

Ananyaa researches sustainable aviation, atmospheric turbulence, and structural engineering, including work exploring a novel aviation method that could reduce carbon emissions by up to 97%. An Arkwright Engineering Scholar, she also developed an IoT smart home system for dementia and designed disaster-resilient homeless shelters.



## James Harcourt | 17 | Dublin

James recently created GlucoBit, a medical device to help people with Type 1 Diabetes for which he has since received funding to bring the device to market. James has a strong business acumen with an interest in embedded systems, software development, and 3D design. James swims competitively and is an avid reader.



## Ethan Quarry | 20 | Cork

Ethan has built multi-agent systems at startups backed by Sequoia & EF including Popcorn and Naviro, where he developed features used by organisations including Blockchain Capital. A former Munster rugby player and nationally ranked sprinter, he has also attended YC Startup School in SF and won a HackEurope prize



## Conall O'Reilly | 17 | Meath

Conall is a neo-cypherpunk with a deep interest in decentralised systems and a strong sense of technological justice. He builds on the Bitcoin network and researches the Ethereum protocol, drawn to the cryptography, economics, and governance questions underneath them. He describes himself as a never-ending void of curiosity.



## Ross Gavin McGirl | 19 | Dublin

Ross is a penetration tester and full-stack developer with a strong interest in ethical hacking, programming, and security automation. He began freelancing in penetration testing at 16 and now works in security tooling in a company. He is currently exploring how AI can be applied to building more adaptive and self-healing security systems.



## Jack McCormack | 17 | Tipperary

Jack has a huge passion for technology, hurling, and making things around him better. He spent a year and a half designing and building a new type of wind turbine for urban areas which has won multiple awards in YSTE and SciFest. He has an enormous interest in sustainability and using engineering to make our world better for future generations.



